

# Weekly Economic Commentary 2 March 2026

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 By [Westpac New Zealand Economics](#)

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Analysis and forecasts of the economy and markets, along with previews of data for the week ahead.



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## The houseless recovery?

In this week's report we look at whether New Zealand can achieve a sustained economic recovery without an assist from rising house prices. In some ways, we already are. For instance, retail spending has consistently risen over the last five quarters, at a time when house prices were effectively flat. However, there are questions about whether this can be maintained in the face of what are still-subdued house price expectations for the year ahead.

We also take a look at the recent conflict in Iran and what this might mean for economic conditions in New Zealand.

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